



▲ **Hindu and Sikh refugees** are seen waiting at the Amritsar railway station after crossing the border for trains to take them to new locations within India. This was a common scene at stations across border towns in India and Pakistan, after Partition in 1947.

People displaced in the Partition had to find some way to get to their country of choice – on foot, in bullock carts, or on trains. In the days that followed 15 August 1947, the railways became one of the most efficient ways to transport millions of people across new borders. In so doing, they became a beacon of hope, but equally a symbol of warring identities, chaos, and bloodshed.

Even as nearly 10 million refugees made their way across the border, more than a million people were massacred. Indian scholar Swarna Aiyer writes in her essay “‘August Anarchy’: The Partition Massacres in Punjab,